

Metropolis/Hastings algorithm.

A distn π (target)

Want to generate n v's from π

$X \sim \pi \quad \mu: EX$

$X_1, \dots, X_n \stackrel{iid}{\sim} \pi \quad \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n X_i = \bar{X} \xrightarrow{SLLN} \mu$

Cannot generate from π either directly or indirectly

Find a Markov chain with transition matrix P

which satisfies $\pi P = \pi$

Generate a Markov chain $Y_1, Y_2, \dots, Y_n$ from P

Under certain conditions $\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n Y_i \rightarrow \mu$

$x, y \rightarrow$ states of Markov chain

$P = (P_{xy}) \quad P_{xy} = \left(\frac{\omega(y)}{\omega(x)} \wedge 1 \right) / d$

Do not know π . But know it upto a const i.e. $\pi(x) = c \omega(x)$

① $d \geq \max$ number of states that you can go to in 1 step from any x .

$d = m(m-1)k(k-1)$

② Restrict to $\pi(x) > 0$

③ What if the $\begin{bmatrix} (i,j) & (i',j') \\ (i,j) & (i',j') \end{bmatrix}$ is zero?

Then stay at x .

Choose i, i', j, j' again from $m \times k$ table.

$x \rightarrow y$

Proposition: The transition probability matrix

$P(x, y) = \begin{cases} \left(\frac{\omega(y)}{\omega(x)} \wedge 1 \right) / d & y \neq x, y \in T \\ 1 - \sum_{y \neq x} P(x, y) & y = x \end{cases}$

is aperiodic and irreducible on T and its unique stationary distribution is π (proof)

Pf: π is a stationary distn of P .

We have shown this in 2 steps

(i) P satisfies the detailed balance eqns

$\pi(x)P(x, y) = \pi(y)P(y, x) \quad \forall x, y$

(ii) If P satisfies detailed balance eqn in π then $\pi P = \pi$

For this eg: Aperiodic. There is some $x \in T$ s.t. that $P(x, x) > 0$

Pick x that has one element 0.

If (i, j') combination is that element then algorithm dictates to stay at x . So $P(x, x) > 0$

Irreducible: You can reach any state y from any other state x . (Tutorial)

General result: Aperiodic & irreducible $P \Rightarrow \pi$ is unique

Thm: Let P be aperiodic, irreducible, positive recurrent

Markov chain on a finite or countable state space X with stationary distn π and let f be a real valued fn on X

such that $\sum_{x \in X} |f(x)| \pi(x) < \infty$, then for any initial

state x , with P probability one,

$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=1}^n f(Y_j) = \mu := \sum_{x \in X} f(x) \pi(x)$

where $Y_1, Y_2, \dots$ is a sequence from P .

Requires Ergodic Thm.

Modifications: d was crucial.

For a general state space X , d may be infinite.

Instead of this $P(x, y) \propto \frac{\omega(y)}{\omega(x)}$ we want a diff P that leads to faster convergence.

$P(x, y) = \left(\frac{Q(y, x)}{Q(x, y)} \wedge 1 \right) Q(x, y)$

where $Q = (Q_{xy})$ is some transition matrix

① $(P)_{xy} = P$ is a transition matrix

② P satisfies detailed balance eqns.

③ $\pi P = \pi$.

[New definition: special case of this with $Q(x, y) = 1/d$]

Continuous case: X is uncountable and π is density on X .

Let Q be a transition f.t. for every $x \in X$, Q has

a density $q(x, \cdot)$, define transition density as

$P(x, y) = \left(\frac{q(y, x)}{q(x, y)} \wedge 1 \right) q(x, y)$

Choice of q : In Metropolis (1953), Q was chosen to be

a symmetric matrix/density. Eg. for density Q could be

normal $q(x, y) = q(y, x)$

$Y \sim N(x, 1) \quad X \sim N(y, 1)$

$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\{-\frac{1}{2}(y-x)^2\}$

Some papers choose $q(x, y) = q(|x-y|)$

Normal also satisfies this

Scale is important: Determines how quickly the chain moves/mixes/ covers the whole space

Very large scale may lead to convergence like a small

scale will move in the same neighborhood.